cricket in the future.

It is in this spirit that I want to make a cricket academy in the northwestern tribal areas, in my home of FATA, which have some of the strongest and most talented kids in the country but, unfortunately, they haven't been able to tap into the mainstream cricket system because of the long-drawn conflict in the region. That's why, if the PCB wants me to, I'd love to do something to strengthen domestic cricket. But I wouldn't do it on the traditional bureaucratic terms, or by being the board's yes-man. I'd do my bit independently only and with the understanding that I have full freedom to make and implement domestic cricket policies. After all, that is the need of the hour.

As for the cricket, I think I will continue till I hang up my boots. The 20-over format has encouraged a 10-over format. And the day is not far when the 10-over format's success will introduce the five-over format.

Despite all my anger about what's wrong with my country and those who run it, I'm bullish about Pakistan. Good things are happening here. Great things, in fact.

My parents' prayers got me to where I am today. Sure, my own hard work helped a little. But the fact that I never had ill intentions for anyone was key. That's how I got to where I am. I help out whomever I can. These are my foundational traits. God helps me because of these traits. The rest, only He knows.

As for the reception to my game even now – people rising to their feet when I make my way, padded up, to the middle, and leaving the stadium when I'm dismissed – and the whole star-power value, well, it's aggression, passion and emotion that make a star. Not just a performance, but a *pyaar* to play, with the right *niyat.*

Yes, I'm a game changer. I changed the way things were done in this great game.

But I'm not a cricketer. I'm simply a player. I love to play. I love to have fun. And I've considered it a privilege and an honour to have entertained millions, not just my fellow countrymen, along the way.